

Donor Onboarding Structure, Reference Document

Surplus Food Redistribution Network (Private Donor Website)

This document captures the agreed donor onboarding flow, donor types, and field-level decisions to guide future build work. It as been implemented

1. Donor Onboarding Flow

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Donor

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Choose donor type

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[Grocery Store / Restaurant / Bakery / Farm / Food Manufacturer / Supermarket / Community Organization]

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Business information

↓

Contact information

↓

Donation information (profile/capacity — NOT a live listing)

↓

Account credentials

↓

Review & submit

↓

Account created

↓

Donor dashboard

...

This same flow applies to **all seven donor types** — no separate registration paths, just conditional fields inside the "Business information" and "Donation information" steps.

2. Donor Types (All Live in MVP)

Unlike the original documentation (which scoped only Grocery Store for MVP and treated the rest as future expansion), this build includes **all seven types** as active donor categories from launch:

1. Grocery Store
2. Restaurant
3. Bakery
4. Farm
5. Food Manufacturer
6. Supermarket
7. Community Organization (as a donor)

3. Business Information — Shared Core + Type-Specific Fields

Design approach: one reusable form component, with a small set of conditional fields shown based on the donor type selected in the previous step. Avoids duplicating seven separate forms.

Shared Core Fields (all donor types)

- Business / Organization Name
- Business Type *(auto-filled from previous step)*
- Address
- Business License / Registration Number (for admin verification)

- Years in Operation *(optional)*

- Website *(optional)*

Type-Specific Fields

| Donor Type | Extra Field(s) |

|---|---|

| Grocery Store | Store size, number of locations |

| Supermarket | Store size, number of locations |

| Restaurant | Cuisine type, seating capacity |

| Bakery | Products typically made |

| Farm | Type of produce grown, seasonal availability |

| Food Manufacturer | Product categories, production scale |

| Community Organization | Organization mission/type, nonprofit status |

4. "Donation Information" at Signup — Clarified Scope

This step is ****profile/capacity information****, not an actual food listing.

| | Signup: "Donation Information" | Post-Login: "Donate Food" screen |

|---|---|---|

| Purpose | Describes the donor's general donation capability | Publishes a specific, real donation |

| Contains | Expected food categories, donation frequency, general pickup availability, storage/refrigeration capability | Food name, quantity, expiration date, specific pickup window, images |

| When filled | Once, during registration (editable later via Profile) | Every time a new donation is created |

| Used for | Helping admins/recipients understand donor capacity ahead of time; can pre-fill defaults on future donation forms | Actual, time-sensitive redistribution transaction |

Suggested Fields for Signup "Donation Information" Step

- Typical food categories expected to donate (produce, bakery, dairy, prepared meals, etc.)
- Estimated donation frequency (daily / weekly / occasional)
- General pickup availability window (e.g., weekday mornings)
- Storage / refrigeration availability (relevant for perishables)

5. Contact Information Step

****Decision:**** The contact person is the same person creating the account (single login, single primary contact — no multi-user org accounts at MVP stage).

Fields

- Contact Person Name
- Job Title / Role (e.g., "Store Manager," "Owner")
- Phone Number
- Email *(this becomes the login email — see Account Credentials below)*
- Preferred Contact Method (Phone / Email / In-app Messages)

****Rationale:**** Most donor organizations (bakeries, farms, single-location stores) won't have a separate admin setting up accounts on someone else's behalf. A single point of contact simplifies verification and keeps communication unambiguous. Multi-user org accounts can be considered as a future enhancement.

6. Account Credentials Step

Fields

- Email *(auto-filled from Contact Information, editable if a different login email is preferred — e.g., a shared inbox like donations@business.com)*
- Password
- Confirm Password
- Terms of Service / Privacy Policy agreement checkbox *(required)*

****Rationale:**** Reusing the contact email by default reduces friction while still allowing overrides. Two-factor authentication is not included at MVP but is a reasonable future enhancement (aligns with "Account Security" mentioned under Settings in the original documentation).

7. Account Created → Verification State

****Decision:**** New accounts are created in a ****Pending Verification**** state, not full dashboard access. This matches the original documentation's verification-before-access model (Chapters 12.2, 12.6, 16.4).

Updated Flow

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Review & Submit

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Account Created

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Pending Verification screen

(org can log in, view status, edit profile —
cannot post donations until approved)

↓

Admin Approves

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Full Donor Dashboard unlocked

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Pending Verification Screen — Suggested Contents

- Status message (e.g., "Your account is under review")
- Estimated review timeframe (if applicable)
- Editable profile/business info while waiting

- No access to: Donate Food, Messages, Pickup Scheduling
- Notification sent automatically ("Account Approved") when admin approves — ties into the platform's existing Notification Module

****Rationale:**** Since donors coordinate real food handoffs with recipient organizations, verification protects the trust model the whole platform depends on. Immediate unrestricted access would undermine that.

8. Open Items for Future Decisions

- Whether Recipient onboarding needs a parallel structure (Food Pantry now; Soup Kitchen, School Meal Program, Community Org, Regional Food Bank per original doc status TBD per your build)
- Verification requirements per donor type (e.g., does Community Organization need nonprofit documentation upload?)
- Whether "Donation Information" profile data should pre-fill the "Donate Food" form fields
- Whether multi-user org accounts (separate login vs. contact person) should be added post-MVP